The Past Conditional

The Past Conditional is used to talk about an event that would have happened (in past) under certain circumstances or conditions.

It translates to: **would have + some action**.

Formation of Past Conditional

Subject + Auxiliary/Helping Verb (Être or Avoir) in Present Conditional + Past Participle of the Main Verb + Rest of the Sentence

Avoir as Auxiliary

Manger - to eat

J'**aurais mangé**	Nous **aurions mangé**
Tu **aurais mangé**	Vous **auriez mangé**
Il/Elle/On **aurait mangé**	Ils/Elles **auraient mangé**

Être as Auxiliary

Venir - to come

Je **serais venu(e)**	Nous **serions venu(e)s**
Tu **serais venu(e)**	Vous **seriez venu(e)(s)**
Il/Elle/On **serait venu(e)(s)**	Ils/Elles **seraient venu(e)s**

Past Conditional of Pronominal Verbs

Se reveiller - to wake up

Je **me serais réveillé(e)**	Nous **nous serions réveillé(e)s**
Tu **te serais réveillé(e)**	Vous **vous seriez réveillé(e)(s)**
Il/Elle/On **se serait réveillé(e)(s)**	Ils/Elles **se seraient réveillé(e)s**

Usage of Past Conditional

To talk about something that would, could, or should have happened but didn't happen in the past.

Dans ce cas, je **serais venu**. (In that case, I would have come.)
À ta place, je **lui aurais parlé**. (In your place, I would have talked to her.)

Si Plus-que-parfait → Conditionnel Passé

Si + plus-que parfait (1st clause), followed by **past conditional** (2nd clause)

Français	English
Si j'étais allé(e) en Espagne, **j'aurais pu** apprendre l'espagnol.	If I had gone to Spain, I could have learned Spanish.
Si nous avions travaillé ensemble, nous **aurions réussi** notre examen.	If we had worked together, we would have passed our exam.
Si elles s'étaient levées plus tôt, elles **ne seraient pas arrivées** en retard.	If they had gotten up earlier, they would not have arrived late.

To Express Regret, Reproach

When it is used as an independent clause, it expresses regret or reproach.

Français	English
J'**aurais pu** lui envoyer le message.	I could have sent her the message.
Nous **aurions dû** acheter la maison.	We should have bought the house.
Elle **aurait dû** s'inscrire à KKarters au lieu de BBarters.	She should have enrolled in KKarters instead of BBarters.

Could Have Been & Should Have Been

Could have been: Pouvoir (in past conditional) + Être (as secondary verb)
Should have been: Devoir (in past conditional) + Être (as secondary verb)

Français	English
Vous **auriez dû** venir me chercher.	You should have been there to pick me up.
Elle **aurait dû** être contente de retrouver son ami.	She should have been happy to meet her friend.
Ils **auraient pu** rester un peu plus longtemps.	They could have stayed a little bit longer.

Past Event That Happened Allegedly or Reportedly

Past conditional is used as a conditional journalistic to express a statement not necessarily confirmed by authorities. To imply some action that took place allegedly or reportedly.

Français	English
Il **se serait enfui** avec sa maîtresse quand sa femme était en voyage.	He reportedly ran away with his mistress when his wife was away on a trip.
Il **aurait volé** la voiture de son voisin.	He allegedly stole his neighbour's car.
Le juge **aurait gracié** Pablo Joshibar, qui avait volé un million de pommes.	The judge reportedly pardoned Pablo Joshibar, who had stolen a million apples.

Negation of Past Conditional

The expression ne...pas is placed around the auxiliary verb.

Français	English
Il **n'aurait pas** dû rentrer si tard.	He shouldn't have returned home so late.
Je **n'aurais pas** été blessé si tu ne m'avais pas poussé.	I wouldn't have been hurt if you hadn't pushed me.
Je **n'aurais plus** dansé parce que j'avais mal aux pieds.	I wouldn't have danced because my feet hurt.

Object/Adverbial Pronouns + Past Conditional

It is placed before the helping verb but if there are two verbs then it is placed before the verb it directly refers to.

Français	English
J'y serais allé s'ils **m'**avaient invité.	I would have gone there if they had invited me.
Tu aurais pu **nous** prévenir des conséquences.	You could have warned us about the consequences.
Nous aurions dû **en** parler.	We should have talked about it.

Interrogative Sentences + Past Conditional

Français	English
Seriez-vous sorti(e) avec moi si je vous l'avais demandé(e) ?	Would you have gone out with me if I had asked you?
Où aurais-tu pu aller si tu n'étais pas venu ici ?	Where could you have gone if you hadn't come here?
J'**aurais dû** accepter l'offre, non ?	I should have accepted the offer, right?